

## ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

### PART A Group Interaction

This article appeared in a newspaper:

#### Carousell

Carousell is one of Singapore's most well-known startup companies, a platform on which users can buy and sell new and secondhand goods.

It has come a long way since 2012, when the startup was awarded \$7,000 to develop a mobile-based marketplace app. Today, it's present in seven markets and valued at US\$1.1 billion.

Carousell was founded by three university friends – Quek Siu Rui, Marcus Tan and Lucas Ngoo. The trio wanted to build an app that would help to declutter the mountain of stuff they'd accumulated. The idea was to build a mobile-first version of US-based classifieds platforms like eBay and Craigslist. They were guided by a simple question: how can we reduce the time it takes to list a product?

For decades, when newspapers dominated the classifieds business, it would take a few days for an ad to show up in the papers. Then came the internet. Online classifieds like Craigslist cut that time to 30 minutes. You'd take a picture with a camera, transfer the file to a computer, connect to the internet and upload the listing.

As smartphones began to hit mass adoption, the founders aimed to build an app that allowed users to upload a listing for secondhand electronics, fashion, even cars and property. All within seconds. Snap, list, sell.



Your school is planning to use Carousell to sell products donated by students for a school fundraising event. You are meeting to discuss this. You may want to talk about:

- the benefits of buying and selling products online
- how to organise the donations for uploading to Carousell
- any problems which might occur from selling products online
- anything else you think is important

### PART B Individual Response

1. Do you buy things online?
2. Do many people sell things online in Hong Kong?
3. Could selling things online become a full-time job?
4. Would you like to start your own business?
5. Will more jobs involve the internet in the future?
6. What are the difficulties of owning your own business?
7. What advice would you give someone starting his or her own business?
8. What qualities make someone a good entrepreneur?